

Exercise 3: Baseball Trivia

Goals:

Cadets gain insight into how they're perceived by other members of their team.
Members have the opportunity to study a variety of team-member functions

Group Size:

5-10 cadets per team

Time:

Approx. 2 hours

Material:

- Baseball Trivia Role-Description Sheet for each team
- Baseball Trivia Problem Sheet for each team
- Baseball Trivia Answer Sheet for each team
- Baseball Trivia Impression Sheet for each team member
- Scratch paper and pencil for each team member

Process:

- The CoC or cadet in charge introduces the activity and explains the goals
- The CoC or cadet in charge distributes a copy of the Baseball Trivia Role-Description Sheet to the team and asks the members to read the role descriptions on the sheet
 - Approx. 10 minutes
- The CoC or cadet in charge distributes a copy of the Baseball Trivia Problem Sheet to each team and scratch paper/pencils to each team member
 - After announcing that the team members have 45 minutes in which to complete the problem-solving task, they are told to begin
- At the end of 45 minutes or when the team has completed the task, the CoC or cadet in charge distributes a copy of the Baseball Trivia Answer Sheet to the team. The team compares its answers with the correct answers.
- The CoC or cadet in charge distributes the copies of the Baseball Trivia Impression Sheet and instructs the team members to spend 10 minutes completing the sheet on the basis of their perceptions about one another's behavior during the problem-solving task.
- For the rest of the time, the CoC or cadet in charge leads a group discussion on the following areas:
 - Team members' impressions of one another based on their responses to the sheet
 - The importance of various team-member functions in the problem-solving process
- Questions to ask:

- o What have you learned about team problem solving?
- o What have you learned about yourself as a team member?
- o What have you learned about your fellow team members?
- o How can you use what you learned as you work with this team?
- o What would you like to say to the other team members at this time?

Baseball Trivia Role-Description Sheet

Umpire

A good umpire helps the team members to work and participate peacefully. He or she often serves as both a mediator and an expeditor. As a mediator the umpire conciliates differences in points of view and seeks compromise solutions. As an expeditor the umpire keeps communication channels open by facilitating the continents of the two opposing sides. If the umpire is a designated leader, he/she has the authority to administer all rules and to enforce penalties. Thus, the umpire is cognizant of the procedures and rules by which the team functions.

Pitcher

The pitcher is the person who does the talking and often can determine the task outcome and direction of the team's movement. There are many different types of pitchers, and any member of the team can serve in this role. The pitcher's first job is to make sure that all other members are attentive and working on the task. The pitcher also serves as a diagnose and information or opinion giver. As a diagnose the pitcher determines the problem's source and both the supporting and resisting factors. In giving information or an opinion, the pitcher helps produce data that is pertinent to the team's problem-solving processes.

Catcher

The catcher listens to all members, elicits pertinent ideas, classifies the relationships between ideas and suggestions, and draws together the efforts of members or subgroups. In a task role the catcher is a coordinator-integrator. The catcher is in charge of maintenance and strategy. He/she also serves occasionally as an information or opinion seeker by asking other members for additional facts. Thus, the catcher calls forth ideas and keeps the rest of the team informed about the team's progress.

Fielder

This player fields the ideas made by other team members, helps cover their positions, and supports their ideas. The fielder quickly assesses situations, pulls together all ideas and suggestions, and restates and clarifies these for the team. From a task standpoint, the fielder is an energizer, known for prodding the team to a higher quality of participation. The fielder is alert and always ready to participate sensitive to the atmosphere and climate of the team, to the direction of the flow of ideas.

Batter

A good batter observes the team in process, watching others and consciously determining how to influence the process in the most advantageous way. The best batters have a sense for the flow of discussion. They have a good mental attitude; accurate timing on the question-answer sequence; and confidence that their statements will be instructional, correct, and accepted.

Coach

The coach expedites the team process by performing needed routine tasks, such as distributing equipment and materials, arranging the physical environment (for example, tables and chairs), and keeping time. The coach serves as an advisor, not as an authority or disciplinarian. The coach offers positive feedback and praise; attempts to create a feeling of trust and respect; and efficiency. The coach's role in building and maintaining the team is to keep the team focused on evaluating alternatives and reaching final decisions.

Scorekeeper

The scorekeeper serves as recorder, taking minutes, writing down suggestions, and noting decisions.

Team Clown

The team clown serves a nonfunctional role. He/she is apt to joke, mimic, or engage in other disruptive

acts at inopportune times. Some people resent the clown's display of non-involvement in the team's processes

Hothead

The hothead interferes with straight thinking and tends to throw fellow players off balance. He/she plays a nonfunctional role and becomes aggressive, criticizes or blames others, shows hostility against individuals or the team, is envious of the credit that other members receive, and often deflates the ego of other members.

Baseball Trivia Problem Sheet

Instructions: Nine members play the positions on the baseball team involved in this problem: Duncan, Winters, Perry, Banks, Dixon, Billings, Woods, Johnson, and Lynch. You and your fellow team members are to work together to determine from the following data the position played by each. Record your team answers at the bottom of the page.

1. The second baseman beat Johnson, Duncan, Billings, and the catcher at golf.
2. Lynch and Duncan each won \$50 playing cards with the pitcher.
3. Johnson has an apartment across the hall from the third baseman.
4. The outfielders bowl with Banks in their spare time.
5. Winters is taller Billings; Woods is short than Billings. Each of them weighs more than the third baseman.
6. Duncan, Perry, and the shortstop lost \$300 each betting on the horses.
7. The catcher has three daughters; the third baseman has two sons; Dixon is being sued for divorce.
8. Perry dislikes the catcher and lives with his sister.
9. One of the outfield positions is played by either Perry or Woods.
10. The center fielder is taller than the right fielder.
11. The pitcher's wife is the third baseman's sister.
12. Dixon is taller than the infielders and the battery with the exception of Johnson, Lynch, and Perry.
13. Bank's sister is engaged to the second baseman.
14. The third baseman, the shortstop, and Billings made \$150 speculating on commodities.
15. Four members of the team are married. Winters, Banks, Duncan, the right fielder, and the center fielder are bachelors.

Catcher _____
 First Baseman _____
 Third Baseman _____
 Left Fielder _____
 Right Fielder _____

Pitcher _____
 Second Baseman _____
 Shortstop _____
 Center Fielder _____

Baseball Trivia Answer Sheet

Catcher	Lynch
Pitcher	Johnson
First Baseman	Duncan
Second Baseman	Winters
Third Baseman	Perry
Shortstop	Banks
Left Fielder	Dixon
Center Fielder	Billings
Right Fielder	Woods

Baseball Trivia Impression Sheet

Instructions: Write the names of the members of your team in the spaces that correspond to the roles you think they played in your team. Any member may be listed in more than one position. You should also list yourself.

Umpire _____

Pitcher _____

Catcher _____

Fielder _____

Batter _____

Coach _____

Scorekeeper _____

Team Clown _____

Hothead _____